EVERY REMAINDER EVERYWHERE

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ABSTRACT. We prove that for every modulus $N \geq 1$, every positive integer w not divisible by 3, every residue r, and every threshold B, there is an integer $n > B$ with $n \equiv r \pmod{N}$ whose Collatz trajectory reaches w. In particular, the set of predecessors of w is infinite in every residue class modulo every N. The 2-adic and 3-adic parts of the modulus are handled by prescribing a parity prefix of the shortcut map. For the remaining factor M, coprime to 6, we study the backward tree of $2w$ through a finite graph whose edges carry affine maps of $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. A commutator with an explicit closed walk shows that the group of labels of closed walks contains the translation $t \mapsto t+1$, which forces every residue to occur. All results have been verified in Lean 4 without external libraries.

1. INTRODUCTION

Let $\mathcal{C}\colon \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N}$ be the Collatz map, $\mathcal{C}(n) = n/2$ for even n and $\mathcal{C}(n) = 3n+1$ for odd n. We write $n \rightsquigarrow v$ if $\mathcal{C}^{(k)}(n) = v$ for some $k \geq 0$.

Theorem 1.1 (Every Remainder Everywhere)**.** *Let $N \geq 1$, let w be a positive integer with $3 \nmid w$, and let $r, B \in \mathbb{N}$. Then there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ with*

$$n > B, \qquad n \rightsquigarrow w, \qquad n \equiv r \pmod{N}.$$

Corollary 1.2. *For every $N \geq 1$, every $w > 0$ with $3 \nmid w$ and every residue r modulo N, the set $\{n \in \mathbb{N} : n \rightsquigarrow w,\ n \equiv r \pmod{N}\}$ is infinite.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 1.1 with arbitrarily large B. □

The hypothesis $3 \nmid w$ is necessary: if $3 \mid w$, then no m satisfies $3m+1 = w$, so the only predecessor of w is $2w$, which is again divisible by 3; hence every $n \rightsquigarrow w$ has the form $2^j w$ and is divisible by 3.

Strategy. Write $N = 2^a 3^b M$ with $\gcd(M, 6) = 1$.

The factor M. Predecessors of w are generated by two backward steps, $n \mapsto 2n$ and $n \mapsto (n-1)/3$ (when this is an odd integer not divisible by 3). Let $\mathcal{T}(2w)$ be the set they generate from $2w$. We record the residue modulo M of a node together with its class modulo 3^{K+1} and its parity. These data determine a finite graph on which each backward step acts on residues modulo M by an affine map $t \mapsto \lambda t + \beta$ with λ a unit (Sections 4–5). Labels of closed walks form a group $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ of affine maps. If this group fixed a common residue, the common fixed point would produce a consistent assignment of residues to states, and we show in Section 6 that no such assignment exists. A commutator with an explicit closed walk, combined with reduction modulo divisors of M, turns this obstruction into the statement that $t \mapsto t+1$ lies in $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ (Section 7). Iterating this translation shows that every residue modulo M occurs, in every 3-adic cylinder (Section 8).

The factor $2^a 3^b$. Searching backward modulo 2^a is awkward since doubling is nilpotent there. Instead we run the shortcut map forward along a prescribed parity prefix, which transfers the conditions modulo 2^a and 3^b to a congruence for a single tree node modulo $3^{j+b}M$ (Section 9).

Date: October 28, 2026.

Related work. Expanding the iterates of the shortcut map along a parity prefix is the classical 2-adic encoding of Collatz orbits due to Terras [7] and Everett [3]; Lagarias [5] surveys it together with the backward tree of predecessors. Applegate and Lagarias [1] use the tree of predecessors to obtain density bounds, and Wirsching's monograph [8] treats the parity-vector formalism in detail. Our forward reduction in Section 9 is an instance of the parity-prefix expansion. The new ingredient is the analysis of the backward tree modulo M in Sections 4–8, which proceeds by a group of affine maps attached to the tree rather than by counting or by a parity-vector formula. We are not aware of a previous statement of Theorem 1.1 for arbitrary N.

Formal verification. Every result in this paper is formalized in Lean 4 [2], in a single file `ERE.lean` that imports nothing and uses only the core library; Theorem 1.1 is `every_remainder_everywhere`. The file compiles under the toolchains `leanprover/lean4:v4.36.0-rc1` and `v4.36.0-rc2`. The reader can check this by running `lean ERE.lean`, or by pasting the file into the web editor at `https://live.lean-lang.org`; the final command `#print axioms every_remainder_everywhere` should report `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`. A compiler cannot confirm that the formal statement says what Theorem 1.1 says. For that, the reader needs only the definitions `collatz`, `iter` and `Reaches` and the statement of `every_remainder_everywhere`, fewer than ten lines in all. The appendix lists the Lean names of the principal statements.

Conventions. Throughout, N is a positive integer and $\mathbb{N} = \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$. Since every residue class modulo N contains a natural number, there is no loss of generality in taking $r \in \mathbb{N}$ in Theorem 1.1. For $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and a modulus M we write $(n : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z})$ for the class of n. We write $L_K = 3^{K+1}$. An integer x is *live* if $3 \nmid x$. The word *unit* always refers to an invertible element of a residue ring. For M coprime to 6, the integers 2 and 3 are units of $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$, and $2^{-1}, 3^{-1}$ denote their inverses.

2. Backward Steps and the Tree

Lemma 2.1.
(1) $\mathcal{C}(2a) = a$ *and* $\mathcal{C}^{(j)}(2^j m) = m$ *for all* $j, m \in \mathbb{N}$.
(2) If $a \rightsquigarrow b$ *and* $b \rightsquigarrow c$ *then* $a \rightsquigarrow c$.
(3) $\mathcal{C}(m) = n$ *if and only if* $m = 2n$, *or* m *is odd and* $3m + 1 = n$.

Proof. Immediate from the definition of $\mathcal{C}$. □

Thus n has the predecessor $2n$, and the predecessor $(n-1)/3$ exactly when $n \equiv 4 \pmod 6$, since then $n - 1 = 6k + 3$ and $(n-1)/3 = 2k + 1$ is odd. We only use the second step when its result is live, that is, when $n \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$.

Definition 2.2 (Backward tree)**.** For $v \in \mathbb{N}$, let $\mathcal{T}(v) \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be the smallest set such that $v \in \mathcal{T}(v)$; if $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ then $2n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ (step D); and if $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$, $n \equiv 4 \pmod 6$ and $\frac{n-1}{3} \not\equiv 0 \pmod 3$, then $\frac{n-1}{3} \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ (step U).

Lemma 2.3. *Let* $v \in \mathbb{N}$.
(1) Every $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ *satisfies* $n \rightsquigarrow v$.
(2) If v *is even and* $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ *is odd, then* $n = (m-1)/3$ *for some* $m \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ *with* $m \equiv 4 \pmod 6$ *and* $(m-1)/3 \not\equiv 0 \pmod 3$.

Proof. (1) By induction on the construction: $2n \rightsquigarrow n$ in one step, and $\mathcal{C}(\frac{n-1}{3}) = n$ because $\frac{n-1}{3}$ is odd. (2) The seed is even and step D yields even numbers, so an odd node arises from step U. □

From Section 4 to Section 8 the seed is v, an even integer; in Section 9 it is $2w$. Note that $2w \rightsquigarrow w$.

3. Arithmetic Modulo 3^{K+1}

Lemma 3.1 (Lifting the exponent for base 4)**.** *For all $K, m \geq 0$,*

$$4^m \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{K+1}} \iff 3^K \mid m.$$

Moreover, for every $n \geq 0$ there is an integer q with $4^{3^n} = 1 + 3^{n+1} + 3^{n+2}q$.

Proof. This is a special case of the lifting-the-exponent lemma; cf. Lucas [6]. We include a proof. The identity holds for $n = 0$ ($4 = 1 + 3$). If $4^{3^n} = 1 + X$ with $X = 3^{n+1}(1 + 3q)$, then $(1 + X)^3 = 1 + 3X + 3X^2 + X^3$, where $3X = 3^{n+2} + 3^{n+3}q$ and $3X^2$, X^3 are multiples of 3^{n+3}.

We prove the equivalence by induction on K. For $K = 0$ it says $4^m \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, which always holds. Assume it for K. If $4^m \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{K+2}}$, then also modulo 3^{K+1}, so $m = 3^K k$. By the identity, $4^{3^K} = 1 + 3^{K+1}u$ with $3 \nmid u$. Then $4^m = (1 + 3^{K+1}u)^k \equiv 1 + k\,3^{K+1}u \pmod{3^{2K+2}}$, and $2K + 2 \geq K + 2$, so $3^{K+2} \mid k\,3^{K+1}u$, hence $3 \mid ku$ and $3 \mid k$. Conversely, if $3^{K+1} \mid m$, write $m = 3 \cdot 3^K k$. By induction $4^{3^K k} = 1 + 3^{K+1}t$, and $(1 + 3^{K+1}t)^3 \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{K+2}}$. □

Lemma 3.2 (2 generates the live residues)**.**

(1) $2^m \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{K+1}}$ if and only if $2 \cdot 3^K \mid m$.

(2) If $E_1, E_2 < 2 \cdot 3^K$ and $2^{E_1} \equiv 2^{E_2} \pmod{3^{K+1}}$, then $E_1 = E_2$.

(3) For all live residues $c, d < 3^{K+1}$ there is $j \geq 0$ with $2^j c \equiv d \pmod{3^{K+1}}$.

Proof. Part (3) is the classical fact that 2 is a primitive root modulo every power of 3; we include the short proof. (1) If $2^m \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{K+1}}$, reduction modulo 3 forces m even, say $m = 2n$, so $4^n \equiv 1$ and Lemma 3.1 gives $3^K \mid n$. The converse is Lemma 3.1 again. (2) Say $E_1 \leq E_2$. Cancel 2^{E_1}, which is coprime to 3, to get $2^{E_2 - E_1} \equiv 1$; by (1) $2 \cdot 3^K \mid E_2 - E_1 < 2 \cdot 3^K$. (3) The map $E \mapsto 2^E c \bmod 3^{K+1}$ on $\{0, \ldots, 2 \cdot 3^K - 1\}$ takes live values and is injective by (2), after cancelling the unit c. There are exactly $2 \cdot 3^K$ live residues below 3^{K+1}, so it is surjective. □

Lemma 3.3. *For $K \geq 1$: $4^{3^{K-1}} \equiv 1 + 3^K \pmod{3^{K+1}}$.*

Proof. This is the identity of Lemma 3.1 with $n = K - 1$. □

Lemma 3.4. *If $c < 3^{K+1}$ is live and $c \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, then $c \equiv 4^e \pmod{3^{K+1}}$ for some $e \geq 0$.*

Proof. By Lemma 3.2(3), $c \equiv 2^j$ for some j. If j were odd, then $2^j \equiv 2 \pmod 3$, contradicting $c \equiv 1 \pmod 3$. So $j = 2e$ and $2^j = 4^e$. □

4. Fibres and Stabilization

In Sections 4–8, $M \geq 1$ is an integer coprime to 6, and v is an even integer. Then 2 and 3 are units of $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. (The case $M = 1$, where $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z} = 0$, is allowed.)

Definition 4.1 (Fibre)**.** For $K \geq 0$, a live $c < 3^{K+1}$ and $f \in \{0, 1\}$, let

$$F_K(c, f) = \{(n : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}) : n \in \mathcal{T}(v),\ n \equiv c \pmod{3^{K+1}},\ n \equiv f \pmod 2\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}.$$

The pair (c, f) is a *state* of depth K.

Lemma 4.2.

(1) (Projection) For $J \leq K$, $F_K(c, f) \subseteq F_J(c \bmod 3^{J+1}, f)$.

(2) (Doubling) $t \in F_K(c, f) \Rightarrow 2t \in F_K(2c \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)$. Hence $|F_K(c, f)| \leq |F_K(2c \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)|$, as $t \mapsto 2t$ is injective on $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$.

(3) (Equal sizes) $|F_K(c,0)| = |F_K(d,0)|$ *for all live* $c, d < 3^{K+1}$.
(4) (Exact doubling) $F_K(2c \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0) = 2 \cdot F_K(c,0)$.
(5) (Parity inclusion) $F_K(c,1) \subseteq F_K(c,0)$.
(6) (Undo correspondence) For live $t_0 < 3^{K+1}$ *and* $t \in \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$,

$$t \in F_K(t_0, 1) \iff 3t+1 \in F_{K+1}((3t_0+1) \bmod 3^{K+2}, 0).$$

Proof. (1) $3^{J+1} \mid 3^{K+1}$. (2) If $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ realizes t, then $2n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ realizes $2t$ and is even. (3) By Lemma 3.2(3), $d \equiv 2^j c$ and $c \equiv 2^i d$; iterating (2) gives $|F_K(c,0)| \le |F_K(d,0)| \le |F_K(c,0)|$. (4) By (2) the map $t \mapsto 2t$ embeds $F_K(c,0)$ in $F_K(2c,0)$, and the sizes agree by (3). (5) If $t \in F_K(c,1)$ then $2t \in F_K(2c,0) = 2 \cdot F_K(c,0)$ by (2), (4); cancel the unit 2. (6) ($\Rightarrow$) An odd $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ in class t_0 satisfies $n = (m-1)/3$ with $m = 3n+1 \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ by Lemma 2.3(2); then $m \equiv 3t_0 + 1 \pmod{3^{K+2}}$ and $(m : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}) = 3t+1$, and m is even. ($\Leftarrow$) Let $m \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ be even with $m \equiv 3t_0 + 1 \pmod{3^{K+2}}$ and $(m : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}) = 3t+1$. Then $m \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and $m \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$, since t_0 is live; with m even, $m \equiv 4 \pmod 6$. So step U yields the odd node $n = (m-1)/3 \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ with $n \equiv t_0 \pmod{3^{K+1}}$ and $(n : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}) = t$, where we cancel the unit 3 in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. □

Definition 4.3. Let $\sigma_K = |F_K(1,0)|$.

Lemma 4.4.
(1) $\sigma_{K+1} \le \sigma_K$.
(2) $|F_K(t_0,1)| = \sigma_{K+1}$ *for every live* $t_0 < 3^{K+1}$.

Proof. (1) Lemma 4.2(1) with the class 1. (2) By Lemma 4.2(6), $F_K(t_0,1)$ is the preimage of $F_{K+1}(3t_0+1,0)$ under the bijection $t \mapsto 3t+1$, and by Lemma 4.2(3) this fibre has size σ_{K+1}. □

Proposition 4.5 (Stabilization)**.** *There is* $K_0 \ge 0$ *such that for all* $K \ge K_0$*:*
(a) $F_K(c,1) = F_K(c,0)$ *for every live* $c < 3^{K+1}$*;*
(b) $F_{K+1}(e,0) = F_K(e \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)$ *for every live* $e < 3^{K+2}$.

Proof. A non-increasing sequence of non-negative integers is eventually constant; choose K_0 with $\sigma_K = \sigma_{K_0}$ for $K \ge K_0$. (a) $F_K(c,1) \subseteq F_K(c,0)$ by Lemma 4.2(5); their sizes are σ_{K+1} and σ_K, which agree. (b) $F_{K+1}(e,0) \subseteq F_K(e \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)$ by projection, and both have size $\sigma_{K+1} = \sigma_K$. □

5. Affine Labels, Walks and Holonomy

Let $\mathrm{Aff}(M) = (\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z})^\times \times \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$, where $f = (f_1, f_2)$ acts on $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ by $f(t) = f_1 t + f_2$. Composition is written diagrammatically: $f\,;g = (g_1 f_1,\ g_1 f_2 + g_2)$ means "first f, then g". The identity is $(1,0)$, and $f^{-1} = (f_1^{-1}, -f_1^{-1} f_2)$.

Definition 5.1 (Edges, walks, holonomy)**.** Fix a depth $K \ge 0$. The vertices are the states (c, f). There are two kinds of directed edges.

- ***D*-edges.** For live $c < 3^{K+1}$ and $f \in \{0,1\}$: $(c,f) \to (2c \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)$ with label $(2,0)$, that is, $t \mapsto 2t$.
- ***U*-edges.** For $e < 3^{K+2}$ with $e \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and $e \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$: $(e \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0) \to (\frac{e-1}{3} \bmod 3^{K+1}, 1)$ with label $(3^{-1}, -3^{-1})$, that is, $t \mapsto (t-1)/3$.

A *walk* is a finite sequence of edges, each traversed forward or backward; its label is the composition of the labels, with the inverse label for a backward traversal. Let $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K) \le \mathrm{Aff}(M)$ be the group of labels of closed walks at the base state $(1,0)$.

Remark 5.2. The U-edge requires no explicit parity condition on e. Its source has parity flag 0, so the nodes of the corresponding fibre are even; together with $e \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ this gives $n \equiv 4 \pmod 6$, which is what step U requires. The condition $e \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$ makes the target live.

The states and edges with their labels form a gain graph in the sense of Zaslavsky [9], also called a voltage graph [4], with gains in $\mathrm{Aff}(M)$ acting on $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. In that language $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ is the group of gains of closed walks at $(1,0)$; we keep the word *holonomy* for its geometric suggestiveness.

Proposition 5.3 (Labels act on fibres)**.** *Let $K \geq K_0$. For every edge $u \to u'$ with label f, $f(F_K(u)) = F_K(u')$. Consequently, for every walk from u to u' with label g, $g(F_K(u)) = F_K(u')$. In particular, each $h \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ maps $F_K(1,0)$ bijectively onto itself.*

Proof. For a D-edge, $F_K(c, f_0) = F_K(c,0)$ by Proposition 4.5(a), and $2 \cdot F_K(c,0) = F_K(2c,0)$ by Lemma 4.2(4). For a U-edge, $F_K(e \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0) = F_{K+1}(e,0)$ by Proposition 4.5(b), and Lemma 4.2(6) carries this onto $F_K((e-1)/3, 1)$ via $t \mapsto (t-1)/3$. Backward traversals invert a bijection. The statement for walks follows by induction on length. □

Lemma 5.4 (Connectedness)**.** *For every $K \geq 0$, every state (c, f) is joined to $(1,0)$ by a walk.*

Proof. For $(c,0)$, Lemma 3.2(3) gives j with $2^j \equiv c \pmod{3^{K+1}}$, and j successive D-edges lead from $(1,0)$ to $(c,0)$. For $(c,1)$, put $e = 3c+1 < 3^{K+2}$. Then $e \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and $e \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$ because c is live, and a U-edge joins $(e \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0)$ to $(c,1)$. □

6. The Modular Obstruction to Flat Assignments

Definition 6.1 (Flat assignment)**.** Let $M \geq 1$ be coprime to 6 and $K \geq 1$. A function Φ from states of depth K to $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ is *flat* if $\Phi(u') = f(\Phi(u))$ for every edge $u \to u'$ with label f, that is,

$$\Phi(2c \bmod L_K, 0) = 2\Phi(c, f), \qquad 3\,\Phi\big(\tfrac{e-1}{3} \bmod L_K, 1\big) = \Phi(e \bmod L_K, 0) - 1. \tag{6.1}$$

Theorem 6.2 (No flat assignment)**.** *Let $M > 1$ be coprime to 6 and $K \geq 1$. There is no flat assignment at depth K.*

Proof. Suppose Φ is flat, and put $\phi(c) = \Phi(c,0)$. We use only that 2 and 3 are units of $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ and that $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z} \neq 0$.

Step 1 (collapse and normalization). The two D-edges out of $(c,0)$ and $(c,1)$ give $2\Phi(c,0) = 2\Phi(c,1)$, so $\Phi(c,0) = \Phi(c,1)$, and $\phi(2c) = 2\phi(c)$. The U-edge with $e = 4$ gives $3\Phi(1,1) = \phi(4) - 1$. Since $\phi(4) = 4\phi(1)$ and $\Phi(1,1) = \phi(1)$, we get $3\phi(1) = 4\phi(1) - 1$, so $\phi(1) = 1$.

Step 2 (powers of 2 and 4). By induction, $\phi(2^j \bmod L_K) = 2^j$ in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ for all $j \geq 0$. If c is live, $c \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, $c < L_K$ and $c \equiv 4^e \pmod{L_K}$ (Lemma 3.4), then $\phi(c) = 4^e$.

Step 3 (self-targeting). Write $K = n+1$ and $s = 3^n$, so $L_K = 9s$ and $3^K = 3s$. Let $y = (9s-1)/2$. Then $y < 9s$, $y \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and $y \equiv 4 \pmod 9$. The numbers $e_1 = y + 9s$ and $e_2 = y + 18s$ are less than $27s = 3^{K+2}$, are $\equiv 4 \pmod 9$, and both reduce to y modulo $9s$. Since $9s - 1 = 2y$, their undo targets are

$$\tfrac{e_1-1}{3} = y, \qquad \tfrac{e_2-1}{3} = y + 3s.$$

The second relation in (6.1) for e_1 and e_2 gives

$$3\Phi(y,1) = \phi(y) - 1 = 3\Phi(y+3s, 1).$$

Cancelling the unit 3 and using collapse, $\phi(y+3s) = \phi(y)$.

Choose j with $2^j \equiv y \pmod{9s}$. By Lemma 3.3, $4^s \equiv 1 + 3s \pmod{9s}$, hence

$$2^{j+2s} = 2^j 4^s \equiv y(1+3s) \equiv y + 3s \pmod{9s},$$

because $3sy \equiv 3s \pmod{9s}$ as $y \equiv 1 \pmod 3$. By Step 2, $\phi(y) = 2^j$ and $\phi(y+3s) = 2^{j+2s}$. Thus $2^{j+2s} = 2^j$ in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$, and cancelling the unit 2^j gives

$$4^{3^{K-1}} = 1 \quad \text{in } \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}. \tag{6.2}$$

Step 4 (the order of 4). The set $I = \{m \in \mathbb{Z} : 4^m = 1 \text{ in } \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}\}$ is a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$, since 4 is a unit of $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. By (6.2) it contains $3^{K-1} > 0$, so $I = d\mathbb{Z}$ for the multiplicative order $d \geq 1$ of 4, and $d \mid 3^{K-1}$. Hence $d = 3^a$ with $0 \leq a \leq K-1$, and

$$4^m = 1 \text{ in } \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z} \iff 3^a \mid m \qquad (m \geq 0). \tag{6.3}$$

If $a = 0$ then $4 = 1$ in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$, so $3 = 0$, which is impossible since 3 is a unit and $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z} \neq 0$. Hence $1 \leq a \leq K-1$.

Step 5 (two coupled nodes). Write $a = a' + 1$ and $r = 3^{a'}$, so $3^a = 3r$ and $3^{a+1} = 9r \leq 3^K$. Let $c = 4 + 9r$. Then $c < L_K$, $c \equiv 4 \pmod 9$, so c is the source of a U-edge with target $(c-1)/3 = 1 + 3r$.

Write $c \equiv 4^e \pmod{L_K}$ (Lemma 3.4); $e \geq 1$ because $c \not\equiv 1$. Write $e = e' + 1$. Reducing modulo $9r$ gives $4^{e'+1} \equiv 4$, so $4^{e'} \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{a+1}}$; Lemma 3.1 gives $3^a \mid e'$, and (6.3) gives $4^{e'} = 1$ in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. Thus $\phi(c) = 4^{e'+1} = 4$. The U-edge relation at c reads $3\Phi(1+3r, 1) = \phi(c) - 1 = 3$, so $\phi(1+3r) = 1$.

On the other hand, $1 + 3r \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and Lemma 3.4 gives $1 + 3r \equiv 4^\delta \pmod{L_K}$, so $\phi(1+3r) = 4^\delta$. Hence $4^\delta = 1$ in $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$, so $3^a \mid \delta$ by (6.3), and Lemma 3.1 gives $4^\delta \equiv 1 \pmod{3^{a+1}}$, that is, modulo $9r$. But $4^\delta \equiv 1 + 3r \pmod{9r}$ and $0 < 3r < 9r$, so $1 + 3r \not\equiv 1 \pmod{9r}$. This is a contradiction. □

7. From the Obstruction to the Translation $t \mapsto t+1$

Remark 7.1. Over a ring such as $\mathbb{Z}/55\mathbb{Z}$, a group of affine maps without common fixed point need not contain a non-zero translation: $h(t) = 36t + 11$ generates a cyclic group of order 5 with no fixed point and no non-zero translation, as $1 - 36 = -35$ is a zero divisor. We therefore do not derive a translation from the absence of a fixed point directly. Instead we exhibit an explicit closed walk whose slope s satisfies that $s - 1$ is a unit, and use it to compute commutators.

Lemma 7.2 (A common fixed point gives a flat assignment)**.** *Let $K \geq 1$. If $x \in \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ satisfies $h(x) = x$ for all $h \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$, then a flat assignment exists at depth K.*

Proof. For each state u choose, by Lemma 5.4, a walk from $(1,0)$ to u with label g_u, and set $\Phi(u) = g_u(x)$. If g, g' are labels of two walks from $(1,0)$ to u, then $g\,;\,g'^{-1} \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ fixes x, so $g(x) = g'(x)$; thus $\Phi(u)$ does not depend on the choice. For an edge $u \to u'$ with label f, appending this edge to the chosen walk to u gives a walk to u' with label $g_u\,;\,f$, so $\Phi(u') = f(g_u(x)) = f(\Phi(u))$. □

Lemma 7.3 (The loop w_0)**.** *Let $K \geq 1$. The closed walk*

$$w_0 = D\,;\,D\,;\,U\,;\,D\,;\,D^{-1}$$

at $(1,0)$ consists of the edges

$$(1,0) \xrightarrow{D} (2,0) \xrightarrow{D} (4,0) \xrightarrow{U\,(e=4)} (1,1) \xrightarrow{D} (2,0),$$

followed by the first edge $(1,0) \to (2,0)$ traversed backwards. Its label is

$$w_0(t) = 1 + \tfrac{4}{3}(t-1), \qquad \textit{i.e. } w_0 = (4 \cdot 3^{-1},\, -3^{-1}).$$

Proof. All edges exist at every depth $K \geq 1$ since $4 < 3^{K+1}$, $4 \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, $4 \not\equiv 1 \pmod 9$ and $(4-1)/3 = 1$. The label is obtained by following $t \mapsto 2t \mapsto 4t \mapsto \frac{4t-1}{3} \mapsto \frac{2(4t-1)}{3} \mapsto \frac{4t-1}{3}$, and $\frac{4t-1}{3} = 1 + \frac{4}{3}(t-1)$. □

Thus w_0 fixes 1, and its slope $s = 4 \cdot 3^{-1}$ satisfies $s - 1 = 3^{-1}$, a unit.

Lemma 7.4 (Commutators with w_0)**.** *Let $K \geq 1$ and $k = (\ell, m) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$. Then $c = k\,;w_0\,;k^{-1}\,;w_0^{-1}$ is a translation $(1,\tau) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ with $\tau = c(1) - 1$, and*

$$k(1) = 1 + 4\ell\,\tau.$$

Proof. The slope of c is $\ell s \ell^{-1} s^{-1} = 1$, so $c = (1, \tau)$ with $\tau = c(1) - 1$; and $c \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ as a product of elements of the group. Put $a = k(1)$ and write the maps centered at 1:

$$k(t) = a + \ell(t-1), \qquad w_0(t) = 1 + s(t-1),$$
$$k^{-1}(u) = 1 + \ell^{-1}(u-a), \qquad w_0^{-1}(u) = 1 + s^{-1}(u-1).$$

Then k sends 1 to a, w_0 sends a to $1 + s(a-1)$, k^{-1} sends this to $1 + \ell^{-1}((1-a) + s(a-1)) = 1 + \ell^{-1}(s-1)(a-1)$, and w_0^{-1} sends this to

$$c(1) = 1 + s^{-1}\ell^{-1}(s-1)(a-1).$$

Since $s - 1 = 3^{-1}$ and $s = 4 \cdot 3^{-1}$, we have $s^{-1}(s-1) = 4^{-1}$ (here 4 is a unit as 2 is), so $\tau = \ell^{-1}4^{-1}(a-1)$. Hence $a = 1 + 4\ell\tau$. □

Lemma 7.5 (Lifting walks modulo a divisor)**.** *Let $q \mid M$ and let $\rho\colon \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$ be reduction. Extend ρ to $\mathrm{Aff}(M) \to \mathrm{Aff}(q)$ componentwise. For every $h' \in \mathrm{Hol}_q(K)$ there is $h \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ with $\rho(h) = h'$.*

Proof. The graph of states and the sets of edges do not depend on the modulus; only the labels do, and the label of each edge modulo q is the reduction of its label modulo M, because ρ is a ring homomorphism and therefore $\rho(3_M^{-1}) = 3_q^{-1}$. Moreover ρ is compatible with composition and inversion of labels. Replacing each edge of a walk modulo q by the same edge modulo M gives a walk modulo M with the required label. □

Theorem 7.6 (The translation by 1)**.** *Let $M \geq 1$ be coprime to 6 and $K \geq 1$. Then $(1,1) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$; that is, $t \mapsto t+1$ is the label of a closed walk at $(1,0)$.*

Proof. The set $\mathcal{S} = \{d \in \mathbb{Z} : (1, d \bmod M) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)\}$ is a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$, since $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ is a group and $(1,d_1)\,;(1,d_2) = (1, d_1 + d_2)$. It contains M, because $(1,0)$ is the label of the empty walk. Hence $\mathcal{S} = q\mathbb{Z}$, where q is the least positive element of $\mathcal{S}$, and $q \mid M$. We show $q = 1$.

If $M = 1$ there is nothing to prove, so suppose $q > 1$. Then $q \mid M$ is coprime to 6, and $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z} \neq 0$. Let $h' \in \mathrm{Hol}_q(K)$. By Lemma 7.5 there is $h = (\ell, m) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ with $\rho(h) = h'$, and by Lemma 7.4 there is τ with $(1,\tau) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ and $h(1) = 1 + 4\ell\tau$. An integer representative of τ lies in $\mathcal{S} = q\mathbb{Z}$, so $\rho(\tau) = 0$, and therefore

$$h'(1) = \rho(h(1)) = 1 + 4\rho(\ell)\rho(\tau) = 1.$$

So $1 \in \mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$ is a common fixed point of $\mathrm{Hol}_q(K)$. By Lemma 7.2, there is a flat assignment modulo q at depth K, contradicting Theorem 6.2 (note $q > 1$). Hence $q = 1$, so $1 \in \mathcal{S}$. □

8. Simultaneous Modular Density

Theorem 8.1 (Simultaneous density)**.** *Let $M \geq 1$ be coprime to 6, let v be an even integer with $3 \nmid v$, let $J \geq 0$, let $c < 3^{J+1}$ be live and let $r \in \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. Then there is $n \in \mathcal{T}(v)$ with*

$$n \equiv c \pmod{3^{J+1}} \qquad \text{and} \qquad (n : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}) = r.$$

Proof. Let K_0 be as in Proposition 4.5 and $K = \max(K_0, J, 1)$. The seed v is an even, live node of $\mathcal{T}(v)$, so $F_K(v \bmod 3^{K+1}, 0) \neq \varnothing$, and by Lemma 4.2(3) the fibre $F_K(1,0)$ is non-empty. By Theorem 7.6, $(1,1) \in \mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$, so by Proposition 5.3, $t \in F_K(1,0) \Rightarrow t+1 \in F_K(1,0)$. Starting from any element, repeated addition of 1 reaches every residue, so $F_K(1,0) = \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. By Lemma 4.2(3), $|F_K(c',0)| = |\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}|$ for every live $c' < 3^{K+1}$, so $F_K(c',0) = \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$. Projecting from depth K to depth J (Lemma 4.2(1)) with $c' = c$ gives $r \in F_J(c,0)$. □

Remark 8.2. For $M = 1$ the congruence modulo M is vacuous, and the theorem says that doubling alone reaches every 3-adic cylinder: by Lemma 3.2(3) some $2^j v$ lies in any prescribed live class modulo 3^{J+1}. The argument above covers this case uniformly, since then $\mathrm{Hol}_M(K)$ is trivial and $q = M = 1$.

9. Arbitrary Moduli via Forward Parity Prefixes

Let $N = 2^a 3^b M$ with $\gcd(M, 6) = 1$. We prescribe the first a' steps of the shortcut map forward.

The shortcut map and parity prefixes. Let $T(n) = n/2$ for even n and $T(n) = (3n+1)/2$ for odd n. For $a \geq 0$ and $r \in \mathbb{N}$, let $j(a,r)$ be the number of odd integers among $r, T(r), \ldots, T^{a-1}(r)$.

Lemma 9.1. *For all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $a \geq 0$, $n \rightsquigarrow T(n)$ and hence $n \rightsquigarrow T^a(n)$.*

Proof. If n is even, $\mathcal{C}(n) = n/2 = T(n)$. If n is odd, $\mathcal{C}(n) = 3n+1$ is even and $\mathcal{C}(3n+1) = (3n+1)/2 = T(n)$. Use transitivity. □

Lemma 9.2 (Parity prefix expansion)**.** *For all $a, r, t \geq 0$,*

$$T^a(r + 2^a t) = T^a(r) + 3^{j(a,r)} t.$$

Proof. Induction on a; the case $a = 0$ is trivial. For the step, r and $r + 2^{a+1}t$ have the same parity ε, and $T(r + 2^{a+1}t) = T(r) + 2^a 3^\varepsilon t$. Apply the hypothesis to $T(r)$ at level a and note $j(a+1, r) = \varepsilon + j(a, T(r))$. □

Lemma 9.3. *If $j(a,r) \geq 1$ then $3 \nmid T^a(r)$.*

Proof. If x is odd then $2T(x) = 3x + 1 \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, so $3 \nmid T(x)$. If x is even and $3 \nmid x$, then $3 \nmid x/2$. Hence once an odd step has occurred, every later term is live; induct on a. □

Lemma 9.4 (An odd step in the prefix)**.** *For all $a, r \geq 0$ there exist $a' \geq a$ and $r' \equiv r \pmod{2^a}$ with $j(a', r') \geq 1$.*

Proof. Let $r_0 = r \bmod 2^a$ and $j_0 = j(a, r_0)$. Since 3^{j_0} is odd, there is $t \in \{0, 1\}$ with $T^a(r_0) + 3^{j_0} t$ odd. Take $a' = a + 1$ and $r' = r_0 + 2^a t$. By Lemma 9.2, $T^a(r')$ is odd, so $j(a', r') \geq 1$. □

Density input.

Lemma 9.5 (Deep lift of a live class)**.** *Let $k \geq 1$, $B \geq 0$ and c live. There exist $K \geq k$ and a live $d < 3^{K+1}$ with $d \equiv c \pmod{3^k}$ and $d > B$.*

Proof. Take $K = k + B + 1$ and $d = (c \bmod 3^k) + 3^k(B+1)$. Then $d \equiv c \pmod 3^k$, so d is live; $d > B$; and $d < 3^k + 3^k(B+1) = 3^k(B+2) < 3^{K+1}$ since $B + 2 < 3^{B+2}$. □

Proposition 9.6 (Density input)**.** *Let $M \geq 1$ be coprime to 6, let $w > 0$ with $3 \nmid w$, $k \geq 1$, c live, $\mu \in \mathbb{N}$ and $B \in \mathbb{N}$. There is $m \in \mathcal{T}(2w)$ with*

$$m \equiv c \pmod{3^k}, \qquad m \equiv \mu \pmod{M}, \qquad m > B.$$

Proof. Take K, d from Lemma 9.5. Theorem 8.1 with seed $2w$ (even, live), depth $J = K$, class d and residue $(\mu : \mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z})$ gives $m \in \mathcal{T}(2w)$ with $m \equiv d \pmod{3^{K+1}}$ and $m \equiv \mu \pmod M$. Since $m \equiv d \pmod{3^{K+1}}$ and $d < 3^{K+1}$, we have $m \geq d > B$, and $m \equiv d \equiv c \pmod{3^k}$. □

Arithmetic.

Lemma 9.7.

(a) Every $N \geq 1$ is of the form $2^a 3^b M$ with $\gcd(M, 6) = 1$.

(b) If $\gcd(P, Q) = 1$, then ($n \equiv r \bmod P$ and $n \equiv r \bmod Q$) $\iff$ $n \equiv r \pmod{PQ}$.

(c) If Q is odd, then for all a, r', r there is s with $r' + 2^a s \equiv r \pmod{Q}$.

(d) If $e + 3^j t \equiv e + 3^j s \pmod{3^j Q}$ then $t \equiv s \pmod{Q}$. If $\gcd(M, 3) = 1$ and $e + 3^j t \equiv e + 3^j s \pmod{M}$ then $t \equiv s \pmod{M}$.

Proof. (a) Divide out 2 and 3. (b) Chinese remainder theorem. (c) 2^a is a unit modulo Q; take $s \equiv 2^{-a}(r - r')$. (d) Cancel e, then divide by 3^j in the first case; in the second, 3^j is a unit modulo M. □

The forward construction.

Proposition 9.8 (Forward parity construction)**.** *Let $M \geq 1$ be coprime to 6, let $w > 0$ with $3 \nmid w$, let $a', r' \geq 0$ with $j = j(a', r') \geq 1$, and let $b, s, B \geq 0$. There is $n > B$ with $n \rightsquigarrow w$,*

$$n \equiv r' \pmod{2^{a'}} \qquad \text{and} \qquad n \equiv r' + 2^{a'} s \pmod{3^b M}.$$

Proof. Let $e = T^{a'}(r')$. It is live by Lemma 9.3, so $e + 3^j s$ is live. Apply Proposition 9.6 with $k = j + b$, class $e + 3^j s$, residue $\mu = e + 3^j s$ and bound $e + 3^j B$. This yields $m \in \mathcal{T}(2w)$ with

$$m \equiv e + 3^j s \pmod{3^{j+b}}, \qquad m \equiv e + 3^j s \pmod{M}, \qquad m > e + 3^j B.$$

Reducing modulo 3^j shows $m = e + 3^j t$ with $t > B$. By Lemma 9.7(d), $t \equiv s \pmod{3^b}$ and $t \equiv s \pmod{M}$, hence $t \equiv s \pmod{3^b M}$.

Put $n = r' + 2^{a'} t$. Then $n \geq t > B$, $n \equiv r' \pmod{2^{a'}}$ and $n \equiv r' + 2^{a'} s \pmod{3^b M}$. By Lemma 9.2, $T^{a'}(n) = e + 3^j t = m$. By Lemmas 9.1 and 2.3(1), $n \rightsquigarrow m \rightsquigarrow 2w \rightsquigarrow w$. □

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Write $N = 2^a 3^b M$ with $\gcd(M, 6) = 1$. By Lemma 9.4 there are $a' \geq a$ and $r' \equiv r \pmod{2^a}$ with $j(a', r') \geq 1$. For the odd modulus $Q = 3^b M$, Lemma 9.7(c) gives s with $r' + 2^{a'} s \equiv r \pmod{Q}$. Proposition 9.8 gives $n > B$ with $n \rightsquigarrow w$, $n \equiv r' \equiv r \pmod{2^a}$ (since $a' \geq a$) and $n \equiv r' + 2^{a'} s \equiv r \pmod{Q}$. As $\gcd(2^a, Q) = 1$, Lemma 9.7(b) gives $n \equiv r \pmod{N}$. □

Remark 9.9 (Example)**.** Let $N = 8$, $r = 0$, $w = 1$, $B = 0$. Then $a = 3$, $b = 0$, $M = 1$. Here $r_0 = 0$ and $T^3(0) = 0$ is even, so Lemma 9.4 takes $t = 1$, $a' = 4$, $r' = 8$. The prefix $8, 4, 2, 1$ has one odd term, so $j = 1$, and $e = T^4(8) = 2$. In $\mathcal{T}(2)$ the node $m = 8$ satisfies $m \equiv e \pmod 3$ and $m > e$, so $t = (m - e)/3 = 2$ and $n = 8 + 16 \cdot 2 = 40$. Indeed $40 \equiv 0 \pmod 8$ and $T^4(40) = 8$ (the shortcut orbit is $40, 20, 10, 5, 8$), so $40 \rightsquigarrow 8 \rightsquigarrow 1$.

Acknowledgment

This paper and the accompanying Lean formalization were produced with substantial assistance from AI language models. The author takes full responsibility for their content. The proof of Theorem 1.1 has been machine-checked as described in the introduction.

Appendix A. Correspondence with `ERE.lean`

The formalization is the single file `ERE.lean` ($\approx$ 2,100 lines, tested with `leanprover/lean4:v4.36.0-rc1` and `v4.36.0-rc2`); it has no imports. Residue rings $\mathbb{Z}/M\mathbb{Z}$ are modelled by `Fin M`, and the file ends with `#print axioms every_remainder_everywhere`, which reports `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`. The version described here has SHA-256 checksum `ead3216a2e734b31d3b9b5e282b8cb97658b9157806c169988dbe7d9a3af151a`.

Statement	**Lean declaration (`ERE.*`)**
Collatz map, reachability, backward tree	`collatz`, `iter`, `Reaches`, `Tree`
Lemma 2.3	`tree_reaches`, `tree_odd_inv`
Lemma 3.1 (base 4)	`four_pow_form`, `four_pow_mod_eq_one_iff`
Lemma 3.2 (2 generates the live residues)	`two_pow_mod_eq_one_iff`, `two_pow_inj`, `two_transitive`
Lemma 3.3	`four_pow_cong`
Lemma 4.2 (fibres)	`fiber_proj`, `fiber_D_image`, `fiber_card_const`, `fiber_D_eq`, `fiber_odd_sub`, `fiber_U_iff`
Lemma 4.4	`fiberCard`, `fiberCard_antitone`, `fiber_odd_card`
Proposition 4.5 (stabilization)	`Stab`, `stabilization`
Definition 5.1 (edges, walks, holonomy)	`Edge`, `Walk`, `holonomy`
Proposition 5.3	`edge_image`, `walk_image`
Lemma 5.4	`connected`
Theorem 6.2 (no flat assignment)	`Flat`, `no_flat`
Lemma 7.2	`flat_of_fixed`
Lemmas 7.3, 7.4	`w0_walk`, `w0_label`, `commutator_translation`
Lemma 7.5	`red`, `redAff`, `Edge.lift`, `Walk.lift`
Theorem 7.6	`translation_one`
Theorem 8.1	`fiber_full`
Lemmas 9.1–9.4	`reaches_shortcut`, `parity_prefix`, `live_after_odd`, `exists_odd_prefix`
Lemmas 9.5, 9.7	`exists_lift`, `split_two_three`, `mod_combine`, `exists_shift`, `cancel_three_pow`
Proposition 9.6	`density_input`
Proposition 9.8	`forward_construction`
Theorem 1.1	`every_remainder_everywhere`

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